



donatelo rigano <donatelo.rigano@gmail.com>

PFAS Drinking Water City of Miami Beach_Follow Up

donatelo rigano <donatelo.rigano@gmail.com>

Mon, Dec 29, 2025 at 9:50 AM

To: "Norris, John" <JohnNorris@miamibeachfl.gov>

Cc: "Knowles, Amy" <AmyKnowles@miamibeachfl.gov>, Commissioner David Suarez <david@davidsuarezmb.com>, "Carpenter, Eric" <EricCarpenter@miamibeachfl.gov>, "Hernandez, Maria" <MariaHernandez@miamibeachfl.gov>, "Baguer, Christina" <ChristinaBaguer@miamibeachfl.gov>, StevenMeiner@miamibeachfl.gov, ricardodopico@miamibeachfl.gov

Hi John and Amy,

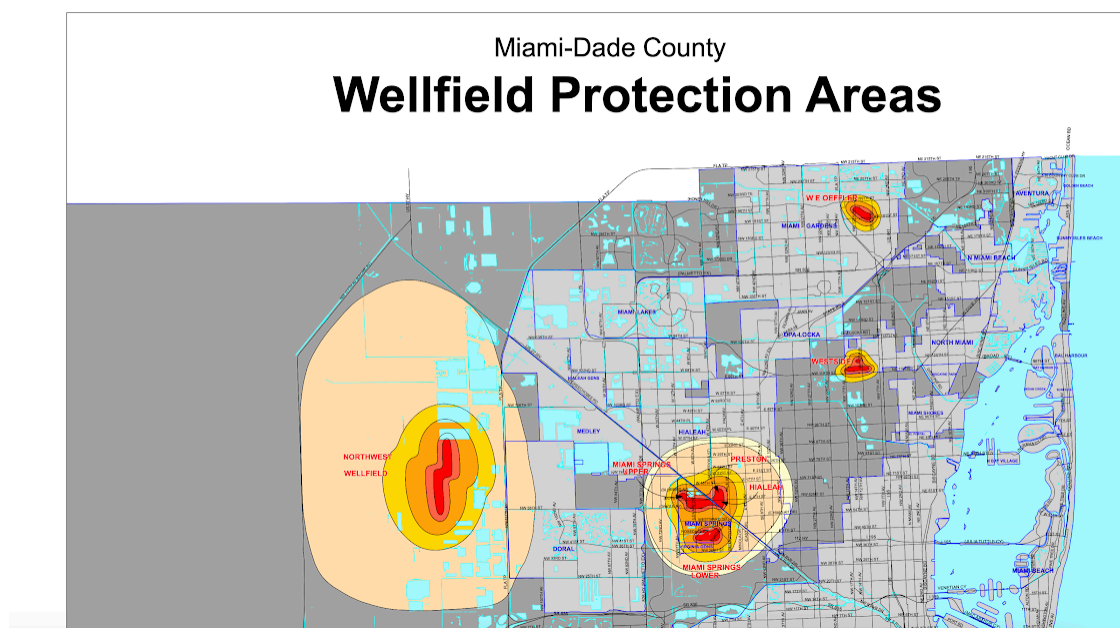
Following up here to previous message. As presented, it looks like the water city of Miami Beach is buying is coming from the County of Miami Dade wells very close to the airport (see below) which is ground zero for the PFAS fire fighting foam contamination, which is likely why its highest by the airport.

Is there any update on getting the water report for chemical contamination levels at each [well in Miami Dade](#)? Specifically the wells to the west are likely very clean and uncontaminated (e.g. Northwest Wellfield) [because according to Miami Dade website, the water travels east \(not west\) so the water to the west would likely be uncontaminated as it is west of the airport](#). Basically in the well map below, the water in the aquifer travels from left to right. New York city had this issue 125 years ago and they decided to get the water from 50 miles away in the cat skills mountain area. In our case, its just a few miles away at an already active well.

Think of the children as according to the EPA children are highly vulnerable to PFAS ("forever chemicals") due to higher intake per body weight, developing systems, and behaviors like crawling/mouthing objects, leading to risks like developmental issues, immune harm, and cancers, with exposure sources including food, water, dust, and breast milk.

At 30 ppt the water you are serving is very dangerous to children, all according to the EPA. So while the EPA is not making you clean it up right now, they are certainly not telling you to claim the water is excellent, safe and show pictures of a child smiling drinking the water (City of Miami Beach Water Quality Report does this which is a copy of the water report from Miami Dade). [In fact EPA actively is stating at these levels this water is dangerous especially for children](#). The people must be alerted to this issue. Schools should be filtered and parents should be alerted immediately.

<https://www.miamidade.gov/environment/library/maps/wellfield-protection-areas.pdf>



On Wed, Dec 24, 2025 at 1:10 PM donatelo rigano <donatelo.rigano@gmail.com> wrote:

Hi John and Amy,

Thank you for meeting with me. Attached is the presentation.

As discussed, here is the link from EPA that states what water filters can be used to remove PFAS from the tap: <https://www.epa.gov/sciencematters/reducing-pfas-drinking-water-treatment-technologies>

Notably it states the following: " High-pressure membranes, such as nanofiltration or reverse osmosis, have been **extremely effective at removing PFAS.**"

Additionally, here is also EPA link which states the dangers of PFAS to children not just firefighters exposed as discussed - <https://www.epa.gov/pfas/our-current-understanding-human-health-and-environmental-risks-pfas>

Feel free to search around (google, chat gpt, perplexity.ai is good for academic research w/ proper citations) the vast amount of peer reviewed **evidence** which shows significant impacts to children, pregnant women and sensitive populations at the PFAS levels the City and County are serving water.

Lastly, I highly recommend updating the 2024 water report that has not been issued yet by the City of Miami Beach (but has been by the county) including but not limited to remove the terms that refer to the water being served as "excellent" and "safe" and also delete pictures of children drinking water. The longer you wait, the more legal risk increases (e.g. Failure to warn, negligent misrepresentation, etc.). Would also warn the public re PFAS levels and use the exact EPA language re .004 ppt, .02 ppt for pfoa pfos, 4 as target MCL and the miami county levels of 30 ppt and higher for the last 5 years or so ...)

Blessings to you all and happy holidays. I am available to discuss further any time.

Gregory Rigano
Miami Beach, FL
305-413-8163
donatelo.rigano@gmail.com

From the EPA last link above:

Our Current Understanding of the Human Health and Environmental Risks of PFAS

What We Know about Health Effects

Current peer-reviewed scientific studies have shown that exposure to certain levels of PFAS may lead to:

- Reproductive effects such as decreased fertility or increased high blood pressure in pregnant women.
- Developmental effects or delays in children, including low birth weight, accelerated puberty, bone variations, or behavioral changes.
- Increased risk of some cancers, including prostate, kidney, and testicular cancers.

- Reduced ability of the body's immune system to fight infections, including reduced vaccine response

Children

Because children are still developing, they may be more sensitive to the harmful effects of chemicals such as PFAS. They can also be exposed more than adults because:

- Children drink more water, eat more food, and breathe more air per pound of body weight than adults, which can increase their exposure to PFAS.

On Sat, Dec 20, 2025 at 3:57 PM donatelo rigano <donatelo.rigano@gmail.com> wrote:
Also do you guys have presentation capability I can connect my computer to like projector power etc?

If not we can just use print outs. Thank you.

On Fri, Dec 19, 2025 at 5:14 PM donatelo rigano <donatelo.rigano@gmail.com> wrote:
Thank you John.

Tuesday Dec 23 at 1 pm?

On Fri, Dec 19, 2025 at 4:20 PM Norris, John <JohnNorris@miamibeachfl.gov> wrote:

Gregory,

I can do any of the times suggested by Amy except that one. I just filled that spot with another meeting. Let me know if any of the other times work.

Thank you,

MIAMIBEACH

John C. Norris, Public Works Director

1700 Convention Center Drive, Miami Beach, FL 33139

Tel: 305.673.7080 | Ext. 27380 | Email: johnnorris@miamibeachfl.gov

www.miamibeachfl.gov

We are committed to providing excellent public service and safety to all who live, work and play in our vibrant, tropical, historic community

From: donatelo rigano <donatelo.rigano@gmail.com>
Sent: Friday, December 19, 2025 4:10 PM
To: Knowles, Amy <AmyKnowles@miamibeachfl.gov>
Cc: Norris, John <JohnNorris@miamibeachfl.gov>; Commissioner David Suarez <david@davidsuarezmb.com>; Carpenter, Eric <EricCarpenter@miamibeachfl.gov>; Hernandez, Maria <MariaHernandez@miamibeachfl.gov>; Baguer, Christina <ChristinaBaguer@miamibeachfl.gov>
Subject: Re: As Art Basel Traffic Hits, Improvements You'll Feel Immediately

You don't often get email from donatelo.rigano@gmail.com. [Learn why this is important](#)

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Thanks Amy and John.

Monday Dec. 22 at noon?

On Fri, Dec 19, 2025 at 4:04 PM Knowles, Amy <AmyKnowles@miamibeachfl.gov> wrote:

Hi Gregory,

I am available to meet at the following times with you and John.

- Monday the 22nd 9:00 – 10am or 12-12:30pm
- Tuesday the 23rd 8:30-10am or 1-2pm

Thanks

Amy

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Amy Knowles, Chief Resilience Officer and Director

ENVIRONMENT & SUSTAINABILITY DEPARTMENT

1700 Convention Center Drive, Miami Beach, FL 33139

Tel: 305.673.7084 | Ext. 26081 | www.miamibeachfl.gov

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From: Norris, John <JohnNorris@miamibeachfl.gov>
Sent: Friday, December 19, 2025 3:38 PM
To: donatelo rigano <donatelo.rigano@gmail.com>; Knowles, Amy <AmyKnowles@miamibeachfl.gov>
Cc: Commissioner David Suarez <david@davidsuarezmb.com>; Carpenter, Eric <EricCarpenter@miamibeachfl.gov>; Hernandez, Maria <MariaHernandez@miamibeachfl.gov>
Subject: RE: As Art Basel Traffic Hits, Improvements You'll Feel Immediately

Gregory,

My schedule is pretty open next week due to most people taking time off. I am happy to meet to discuss. Please let me know your availability.

Thank you,

MIAMIBeach

John C. Norris, Public Works Director

1700 Convention Center Drive, Miami Beach, FL 33139
Tel: 305.673.7080 | Ext. 27380 | Email: johnnorris@miamibeachfl.gov
www.miamibeachfl.gov

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From: donatelo rigano <donatelo.rigano@gmail.com>
Sent: Friday, December 19, 2025 12:23 PM
To: Knowles, Amy <AmyKnowles@miamibeachfl.gov>
Cc: Commissioner David Suarez <david@davidsuarezmb.com>; Norris, John <JohnNorris@miamibeachfl.gov>; Carpenter, Eric <EricCarpenter@miamibeachfl.gov>; Hernandez, Maria <MariaHernandez@miamibeachfl.gov>
Subject: Re: As Art Basel Traffic Hits, Improvements You'll Feel Immediately

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Hi John and Amy

It would be great to meet in person to discuss this matter further. Are you available before the holidays by any chance? There are likely relatively easy solutions that can be implemented quickly. Thank you.

Gregory Rigano

Miami Beach, FL

305-413-8163

On Wed, Dec 3, 2025 at 5:38 PM Knowles, Amy <AmyKnowles@miamibeachfl.gov> wrote:

Good evening Commissioner Suarez and Mr. Rigano,

Thank you for sharing this information. The City of Miami Beach purchases its potable water from Miami-Dade County, which adheres to both federal and local requirements. PFAS is indeed a complex and pressing issue, and as new regulations are instituted, Miami-Dade County will need to address them accordingly. It's important to note that the City doesn't have its own potable water quality treatment system.

I'm also copying John Norris, our Public Works Director, in case you need any additional information regarding this matter.

Best regards,

Amy Knowles

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Amy Knowles, Chief Resilience Officer and Director

ENVIRONMENT & SUSTAINABILITY DEPARTMENT

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Tel: 305.673.7084 | Ext. 26081 | www.miamibeachfl.gov

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From: Commissioner David Suarez <david@davidsuarezmb.com>
Sent: Tuesday, December 2, 2025 11:16 PM
To: donatelo rigano <donatelo.rigano@gmail.com>
Cc: Knowles, Amy <AmyKnowles@miamibeachfl.gov>
Subject: Re: As Art Basel Traffic Hits, Improvements You'll Feel Immediately

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Got it.

Thank you for sending this over and for including the screenshot. I've CC'ed our Environmental Director on this so the team can review the PFAS information and the suggestions you raised.

Best,
David Suarez
Miami Beach City Commissioner

On Tue, Dec 2, 2025 at 5:51 PM donatelo rigano <donatelo.rigano@gmail.com> wrote:

it is coming from the airport (MIA) and miami beach buys its water from miami dade. its just in the miami beach annual water report which is copy and pasted from miami dade

<https://www.miamibeachfl.gov/wp-content/uploads/2024/10/CMB-Water-Quality-2023.pdf>

i screen shotted it here which is the bottom of page 8 of 20 of the water quality report. reverse osmosis gets it out over 99%. its a simple technology that miami beach should install for its residents:

2023 ADDITIONAL CONTAMINANTS MONITORING**					
PARAMETER	FEDERAL MCL (a)	FEDERAL GOAL (b)	STATE MCL	YEAR TESTED	MAIN SYSTEM
Perfluorooctane sulfonate (ppt)	N/A	N/A	N/A	23 (h)	38 (ND-38)
Perfluorooctanoic acid (ppt)	N/A	N/A	N/A	23 (h)	30 (ND-30)

On Tue, Dec 2, 2025 at 3:08 PM Commissioner David Suarez <david@davidsuarezmb.com> wrote:

Donatelo,

Can you please clarify where you're seeing this and how you know the PFAS level is 30? I want to make sure I fully understand the source of the information so I can look into it immediately.

Thank you for bringing it to my attention.

David Suarez
Miami Beach City Commissioner

On Tue, Dec 2, 2025 at 9:56 AM donatelo rigano <donatelo.rigano@gmail.com> wrote:

the drinking water is cancer causing with PFAS levels at 30. the epa states anything above 4 is really really bad and you are serving this unfiltered to children and pregnant women

On Tue, Dec 2, 2025 at 8:03 AM David Suarez <david@davidsuarezmb.com> wrote:

From Meridian to Alton Road, we're fixing problem lights across the city.

Dear Miami Beach Neighbors,

I hope you all had a wonderful Thanksgiving. We have a lot to be grateful for as a community — including the fact that people from all over the world choose Miami Beach as their destination. Their visits help support our local businesses and keep our economy strong. But with that popularity comes one thing we all feel: **traffic**.

And with **Art Week (December 1–7) now here**, we're already seeing an increase in visitors, events, and activity across the city. To help manage the additional volume, the City has expanded trolley service, activated dedicated shuttle routes, and brought back the Miami–Miami Beach water taxi. You can find more details [here](#).

While the city manages the Art Week surge, I've also been working closely with our Transportation Department on everyday fixes you'll feel on your daily routes.

Free Art Week shuttles and water taxi routes connecting Miami and Miami Beach.

Your Feedback Is Making a Real Difference

Earlier this fall, I asked residents to share which traffic issues were affecting their neighborhoods. I read every comment and immediately followed up with Transportation Director Jose Gonzalez. Thanks to your feedback, we've already completed several improvements across Meridian Avenue, Alton Road, and the Fisher Park area.

Meridian Corridor Signal Fixes You Helped Identify

Here's what has already been completed:

- Shortened side-street green lights that were triggering with no cross-traffic.
- Repaired pedestrian buttons that stopped traffic unnecessarily.
- Extended north/south green time to move more cars through each cycle.
- Fixed faulty vehicle detection equipment causing long red cycles.
- Adjusted timing near Lincoln Road to reduce peak-hour backups.
- Repaired the 17 Street detector, eliminating recurring delays.

Alton Road & 15 Street

Residents notified us that the pedestrian signal here was activating automatically even without pedestrians present — causing unnecessary red lights. The issue has now been resolved.

Pilot Project: Thermal Sensors at Delaware Ave

At the Fisher Park intersection, residents raised concerns about constant pedestrian recalls. We're now moving forward with **passive thermal pedestrian detection** — a technology requiring no physical interaction and respecting Sabbath observance while improving traffic flow.

This will be the **first installation of this technology anywhere in Miami-Dade County**. A demonstration was completed, and we are preparing the documents required for County approval.

Help Us Catch Issues Quickly

If you notice a traffic light that seems off or out of sync, simply **reply to this email**. Every report helps us make targeted, meaningful improvements.

With Art Week already underway, please plan your travel around peak event times when possible. In my next newsletter, I'll share updates on **traffic signal synchronization** and expanded access to

HOV/Express lanes — two long-term improvements that will make a real difference.

Thank you for your continued feedback and trust. Together, we're keeping Miami Beach moving.

Warm regards,

David Suarez

Miami Beach City Commissioner

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David Suarez

Paid for by David Suarez, Miami Beach Commissioner Group 5

[421 Meridian Ave](#)

[Miami Beach, FL 33139](#)